City of Saint Paul

City Hall and Court House
15 West Kellogg Boulevard
Council Chambers - 3rd Floor
651-266-8560

Meeting Minutes

City Council

Council President Rebecca Noecker
Vice President Nelsie Yang
Councilmember Anika Bowie
Councilmember Molly Coleman
Councilmember Cheniqua Johnson
Councilmember Saura Jost
Councilmember HwaJeong Kim

Wednesday, September 2, 2026 **3:30 PM** **Council Chambers - 3rd Floor**

ROLL CALL

Meeting started at 3:30 PM

Present 7 - Councilmember Rebecca Noecker, Councilmember Nelsie Yang, Councilmember HwaJeong Kim, Councilmember Anika Bowie, Councilmember Saura Jost, Councilmember Cheniqua Johnson and Councilmember Molly Coleman

COMMUNICATIONS & RECEIVE/FILE

1 AO 26-61 Establishing two (2) new projects through the Neighborhood STAR Year-Round Program as adopted via City Council Resolution #- RES 26-1317 and RES 26-1319.

Received and Filed

CONSENT AGENDA
Items listed under the Consent Agenda will be enacted by one motion with no separate discussion. If discussion on an item is desired, the item will be removed from the Consent Agenda for separate consideration.

Approval of the Consent Agenda

City Clerk Nicole Tillander stated that Item 4 was withdrawn.

Council President Noecker stated that Items 16, 30, and 31 would be taken separately.

Councilmember Yang moved approval.

Consent Agenda adopted as amended

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

2 RES 26-1202 Authorizing the Department of Public Works to apply for federal funding from the Highway Safety Improvement Program administered by the Metropolitan Council, which has a match requirement, to support safety improvements on TH51 (Snelling Avenue).

Adopted

3 RES 26-1226 Approving the City's cost of providing Collection of Vacant Building Registration fees billed during August 2025 to May 2026, and setting date of Legislative Hearing for September 29, 2026 and City Council public hearing for October 14, 2026 to consider and levy the assessments against individual properties. (File No. VB2603, Assessment No. 268906)

Adopted

4 RES 26-1298 Approving the City's cost of providing Collection of Vacant Building Registration fees billed during April 2026, and setting date of Legislative Hearing for September 29, 2026 and City Council public hearing for January 6, 2027 to consider and levy the assessments against individual properties. (File No. VB2604, Assessment No. 268907) (to be withdrawn)

Withdrawn

5 RES 26-1320 Approving assessment costs and setting date of City Council public hearing to ratify the assessment for the Mill and Overlay on Concordia/Rondo from Snelling to Marion as part of the 2024 Mill and Overlay Program (Project No. MO2403B, Assessment No. 255503).

Adopted

6 RES 26-1324 Approving assessment costs and setting date of City Council public hearing to ratify the assessment for the Jackson Street: University to Pennsylvania street reconstruction project as part of the 2025 Saint Paul Streets and Sales Tax Street Program (Project No. 19271, Assessment No. 255203).

Adopted

7 RES 26-1331 Approving assessment costs and setting date of City Council public hearing to ratify the assessment for the Wheelock/Grotto Residential Area Street Reconstruction Project as part of the 2025 Saint Paul Streets and Sales Tax Street Program (Project No. 19270, Assessment No. 255202).

Adopted

8 RES 26-1358 Approving assessment costs and setting date of City Council public hearing to ratify the assessment for the Mill and Overlay in the Fourth/Howard, Phase II project area as part of the 2025 Mill and Overlay Program (Project No. MO2501, Assessment No. 255504).

Adopted

9 RES 26-1366 Approving assessment costs and setting date of City Council public hearing to ratify the assessment for the Mill and Overlay for Front Avenue from Rice to Western, as part of the 2024 Mill and Overlay Program (Project No.

MO2306, Assessment No. 245506).

Adopted

10 RES 26-1379 Approving assessment costs and setting date of City Council public hearing to ratify the assessment for the Mill and Overlay on George Street from Cherokee to Cesar Chavez as part of the 2025 Mill and Overlay Program (Project No. MO2503, Assessment No. 255506).

Adopted

11 RES 26-1383 Approving assessment costs and setting date of City Council public hearing to ratify the assessment for the Mill and Overlay on Eustis Street from the City limits to 100 feet south of the City limits as part of the 2025 Mill and Overlay Program (Project No. MO2504, Assessment No. 255507).

Adopted

12 RES 26-1385 Approving the application for change of ownership to the Second Hand Dealer - Motor Vehicle license (License ID #DSIBLAUTO-002364-2026) now held by EMR Auto Sales LLC d/b/a EMR Auto Sales for the premises located at 1414 Arcade St.

Adopted

13 RES 26-1386 Authorizing the Department of Parks and Recreation to apply for up to $3,040,0000 from the Minnesota Arts and Cultural Heritage Fund Legacy grant.

Adopted

14 RES 26-1389 Approving assessment costs and setting date of City Council public hearing to ratify the assessment for the replacement of sanitary sewer services within the right-of-way as part of the Annapolis Street paving project. File No. 19249C, Assessment No. 266001.

Adopted

15 RES 26-1394 Approving assessment costs and setting date of City Council public hearing to ratify the assessment for the Robert Street: Kellogg to 11th street reconstruction project as part of the 2024 Saint Paul Streets Program (Project No. 19263, Assessment No. 255201).

Adopted

17 RES 26-1400 Approving the Labor Agreement (January 1, 2026 - December 31, 2028) and Memorandums of Agreement between the City of Saint Paul and the Saint Paul Manual & Maintenance Supervisors Association.

Laid over to September 9, 2026

18 RES 26-1402 Approving the Memorandum of Agreement between the City of Saint Paul and the United Association of Plumbers, Local 34, for the purpose of establishing mandatory contributions for the utilization of the Minnesota Paid Leave program.

Laid over to September 9, 2026

19 RES 26-1408 Approving assessment costs and setting date of City Council public hearing to ratify the assessment for the replacement of sanitary sewer services within the right-of-way as part of the Griggs Scheffer Phase II paving project. File No. 19233C, Assessment No. 266002.

Adopted

20 RES 26-1415 Approving assessment costs and setting date of City Council public hearing to ratify the assessment for the replacement of sanitary sewer services within the right-of-way as part of the Grand: Fairview to Snelling paving project. File No. 19265C, Assessment No. 266003.

Adopted

21 RES 26-1417 Approving assessment costs and setting date of City Council public hearing to ratify the assessment for the replacement of sanitary sewer services within the right-of-way as part of the Jackson: University to Pennsylvania paving project. File No. 19271C, Assessment No. 266004.

Adopted

22 RES 26-1419 Approving assessment costs and setting date of City Council public hearing to ratify the assessment for the replacement of sanitary sewer services within the right-of-way as part of the Pelham: Franklin to Mississippi River Blvd paving project. File No. 19275C, Assessment No. 266005.

Adopted

23 RES 26-1422 Approving assessment costs and setting date of City Council public hearing to ratify the assessment for the Grand Ave. from Fairview Ave. N. to Snelling Ave. street reconstruction project as part of the 2024 Saint Paul Streets and Sales Tax Street Program (Project No. 19265, Assessment No. 245204).

Adopted

24 RES 26-1429 Authorizing the Parks and Recreation Department to accept the donation of a six-passenger golf cart valued at $10,000 from The Toro Company.

Adopted

25 RES 26-1438 Approving assessment costs and setting date of City Council public hearing to ratify the assessment for the replacement of sanitary sewer services within the right-of-way as part of the Wheelock-Grotto Phase I paving project. File No. 19270C, Assessment No. 266006.

Adopted

26 RES 26-1474 Approving the Mayor's reappointment of Samantha Juneau to the Administrative Committee of the Pension Plan of the Housing and Redevelopment Authority.

Adopted

27 RES 26-1480 City Council approval of the Development Agreement, Use Agreement, and Disbursement Agreement between the Department of Parks and Recreation and The Sanneh Foundation for Conway Park.

Adopted

28 RES 26-1484 Approving the Mayor's appointment of Molly Coleman to the Workforce Innovation Board of Ramsey County.

Adopted

29 RES 26-1489 Celebrating the 50th Anniversary of Seal Hi-Rise.

Adopted

FOR DISCUSSION

SUSPENSION ITEM

RES 26-1544 Appointing the Public Rights Project (PRP) as special counsel for the purpose of providing legal representation to the City of Saint Paul in affirmative litigation to challenge a federal rule related to grants.

Council President Noecker spoke to the item and moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

16 RES 26-1399 Authorizing the Police Department to apply to the FY 2026 CPD Microgrants Program from the U.S. Department of Justice. (Laid over from September 2, 2026)

Kurt Hallstrom, Deputy Police Chief, gave a staff report and answered councilmember questions.

Councilmember Yang expressed concerns and moved to lay over for one week.

Councilmembers Coleman and Kim stated their opposition.

Laid over to September 9, 2026

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

31 RES 26-1492 Appointing Korinne Dennis as Communications Lead, Reggie Evans as Reparations Legislative Aide and Joanna Zimny as Legislative Hearing

Officer.

Council President Noecker moved approval.

Korinne Dennis, Reggie Evans, and Joanna Zimny were sworn in.

Adopted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

32 SR 26-186 Staff report on the State of our Youth address.

Jacy Johnson Becker, Ward 5 intern, gave a staff report.

Councilmember Kim gave remarks.

Received and Filed

30 RES 26-1493 Proclaiming September 2nd, 2026 as Jacy Johnson Becker Day in the City of Saint Paul

Councilmember Kim read from the resolution, spoke in favor, and moved approval.

Jacy Johnson Becker, Ward 5 intern, gave remarks.

Councilmembers Yang and Noecker spoke in favor.

Adopted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

PUBLIC HEARINGS
Live testimony is limited to two minutes for each person. See below for optional ways to testify.

33 RES PH 26-210 Approving the application of University of Saint Thomas for a sound level variance in order to present amplified sound for Tommie Fest Homecoming event on Friday, September 25, 2026, at 2115 Summit Avenue - J.P. Monahan Plaza.

Councilmember Coleman moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

34 RES PH 26-217 Approving the application of University of Saint Thomas for a sound level variance in order to present amplified sound for the Cretin Derham Hall Football events on Thursday, October 8, and Wednesday, October 21, 2026, at 2115 Summit Avenue - O'Shaughnessy Stadium.

Councilmember Coleman moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

35 RES PH 26-221 Approving the application of Anderson Race Management for a sound level variance in order to present amplified sound for a Walk for Water event on Saturday, September 26, 2026, at 226 Spring Street - Upper Landing Park.

Councilmember Jost moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

36 RES PH 26-222 Amending the spending plan in the Fire Department Public Safety Aid projects to more accurately account for the expenditures.

Councilmember Bowie moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

37 RES PH 26-236 Amending the financing and spending plans in the Fire Department in the amount of $108,118.15 for the contribution received from the Minnesota Board of Firefighter Training and Education to pay for training for firefighters.

Councilmember Johnson moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

38 RES PH 26-237 Amending the financing and spending plans in the Fire Department in the amount of $8,500 for a payment received for selling a trailer that was no

longer needed for department use.

Councilmember Yang moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

39 RES PH 26-238 Amending the financing and spending plans in the Fire Department in the amount of $37,000 for the amount received from the sale of the land located at 1683 Energy Park Drive.

Councilmember Kim moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

LEGISLATIVE HEARING DISCUSSION ITEM

40 RLH RR 26-16 Amending Second Making finding on the appealed substantial abatement ordered for 947 FREMONT AVENUE in Council File RLH RR 25-34. (Public hearing closed and laid over from August 19, 2026)

Found incomplete. $2,500 of remaining $10,000 forfeited. $2,500 to be forfeited every 45 days until project completes or money exhausted.

Marcia Moermond, Legislative Hearing Officer: This has been before you a few times. Two weeks ago, you laid this over to ask for additional information on how much of the work is completed, to help make your decision on forfeiture of the performance deposit. I previously recommended that $5,000 of the posted $15,000 performance deposit be forfeited, with $2,500 to be forfeited every subsequent month that the project remains incomplete, until the deposit runs out. You voted to do so. This item is to make a finding on that first subsequent month. Your options are to:
1) Not forfeit any additional money.
2) Forfeit less frequently than once a month or forfeit less money.
3) Require an additional performance deposit. If you go this route I suggest no less than $10,000.
Some info was added to the record right before the meeting and has been placed in front of you and in Legistar. It is from Jay Mitchell, who is representing the owner. He provided an engineering report to show that progress is being made, though yesterday morning's inspection showed 5% completion. This is a negligible increase from the 0% two weeks ago.

Councilmember Johnson: The City found 5% completion?

Moermond: Yes.

Johnson: How many months away from completion are they? What have they

shared?

Moermond: They're working off a 180-day grant of time, which is standard. I can get more details if need be.

Johnson: What is the remaining balance?

Moermond: $10,000 of $15,000. My recommendation is to further forfeit increments of $2,500 each month work remains not done, starting with this making finding. The owners have indicated that it is impossible for them to reach completion before the deposit is all forfeited, which would take place before the 180-day grant of time completes.

Johnson: How much would the monthly forfeiture be to align with the 180-day grant of time?

Moermond: I can work on computing that.

Johnson: I don't have an issue with the forfeiture. I am concerned about the incremental forfeiture not aligning with the 180-day grant of time. My amendment is to align the two things.

Moermond: That would mean forfeiting the $2,500 every subsequent 45 days.

Johnson: I move that amendment.

Council President Noecker: So, forfeit $2,500 and another $2,500 every 45 days until the work completes?

Councilmember Yang: I support that.

Adopted (forfeit $2,500 and forfeit remaining deposit by $2,500 every 45 days)

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

46 RLH TA 26-158 Ratifying the Appealed Special Tax Assessment for property at 777 OHIO STREET. (File No. J2602A, Assessment No. 268503)

Referred to October 6, 2026 Legislative Hearing.

Jessica Klasen, property representative, appeared in person.
Adam Lind, relative of property representative, appeared in person.

Marcia Moermond, Legislative Hearing Officer: This is an assessment for an interior abatement to repair a sewer line. The property was referred by Police to the Department of Safety and Inspections (DSI) for having dangerous conditions on March 8, 2026. DSI staff responded the next day. An inspection occurred not long after, but DSI was denied access to the house. The Police referred stated that the woman was living alone with stage 4 cancer, and there was black mold and sewage backing up to create nonlivable conditions. She couldn't afford to fix her plumbing and couldn't flush her toilets for weeks.

An outside contractor did work in April to clear the sewer line. The $6,868 charge is for that work, which includes fees. The contractor said it was the worst sewer backup

they'd ever seen involving nonflushable products. There were two no-show Legislative Hearings on this, where we made 5 phone calls to the property representative. The owner passed away in May. Information has been attached to the file alleging that the sewer line was in bad condition and that the city contractor did the job incorrectly. The testifier today can correct me on that if I'm wrong. There is also a statement attached from a plumber who had similar comments.
The House Calls program provided two large dumpsters to remove items from the house. I don't know if the DSI inspector said House Calls would be cleaning the floor, but it's also alleged that that did not happen. I need more information, and I have no hearing fall back on, so my recommendation is to ratify the assessment and make it payable over one year. The City did this to allow the owner to stay in their home for their hospice care.

Council President Noecker: What are the formal circumstances for us to do an interior abatement and assess the cost for that?

Moermond: DSI needs to determine that it is a public nuisance. Past examples include rat and cockroach infestations that impact neighboring properties. The issue here was probably the spread of germs in a small area, due to the sewage. The owner also wanted to do this work.

Noecker: This was done with consent of the property owner?

Moermond: Yes, which allowed her to stay in the home.

Noecker: I think it's best to send this back to Legislative Hearing, but we will hold the public hearing.

Jessica Klasen: This was my mom's house. Ramsey County is charging for work they claim was done. I dispute these charges because I have evidence showing the work was not done. This includes photos, videos, and invoices from a licensed plumber. The plumber inspected and performed work after my mom passed away. The evidence shows that other than installation of new pipe, the work was either not done or not necessary. The plumber addressed the actual issue, which contradicts certain descriptions of the plumbing that were used to justify the City's charges. Please dismiss or fix these charges.

Adam Lind: Before the owner died, Jessica was in South Carolina. The owner was my mom's sister, and I was dealing with the plumbing issue when I learned about my aunt's health issues. I talked with DSI inspectors. I was told that billed work was purposefully not done because they didn't think it was needed, and all they needed to do was get a jet truck out to jet the line. The charges are for digging and jetting the pipe. The digging and replacing pipe charge should not be there, as they never did it. We aren't disputing the whole bill. The receipts also claim there is a three-month warranty for the work. The work was done in April and we were calling in May, but no one would come out to warranty it. The owner was in the hospital for three weeks and came home to a basement that was still flooded. It was still unsafe for her, and that's where the City got involved. The ball got dropped somewhere. I don't want Jessica to be responsible for something that wasn't done.

Noecker moved to close the public hearing. Approved 7-0.

Noecker: Because there are factual disputes, and because the City Council has a Legislative Hearing process for looking into these disputes, I would like to refer this matter to Legislative Hearings.

Moermond: Could it be referred to Legislative Hearings on October 6, 2026?

Noecker: So moved.

Referred to October 6, 2026 Legislative Hearing (Public hearing on October 14, 2026)

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

LEGISLATIVE HEARING CONSENT AGENDA

Items listed under the Consent Agenda will receive a combined public hearing and be enacted by one motion with no separate discussion. Items may be removed from the Consent Agenda for a separate public hearing and discussion if desired.

Approval of the Consent Agenda

Councilmember Yang moved approval.

Legislative Hearing Consent Agenda adopted as amended

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

41 RLH SAO 26-77 Appeal of Barbara Clark to a Summary Abatement Order at 1552 CANFIELD AVENUE.

Adopted

42 RLH RSA 26-20 Appeal of Robert Fox to a Rent Stabilization Determination at 1640 EDGERTON STREET.

Public hearing continued to September 9, 2026

43 RLH RSA 26-21 Appeal of Carli Valez, Tenant, to a Rent Stabilization Determination at 1640 EDGERTON STREET.

Public hearing continued to September 9, 2026

44 RLH FCO 26-71 Appeal of Greg Heck, Montrose Pl LLC, to a Fire Certificate of Occupancy Correction Notice at 221 MONTROSE PLACE.

Adopted

45 RLH VBR 26-17 Appeal of John Ludwig, Superior Financing Inc, to a Vacant Building Registration Requirement at 12 OAKLEY AVENUE.

Adopted

47 RLH SAO 26-60 Appeal of Erin Metz Verdeja to a Summary Abatement Order at 1518 SELBY AVENUE.

Public hearing continued to September 9, 2026

48 RLH RSA 26-19 Appeal of Matthew and James Lindquist to a Rent Stabilization Determination at 1501 SEVENTH STREET W Units 6 and 8.

Adopted

49 RLH SAO 26-71 Appeal of Barry Campbell to a Summary Abatement Order at 449 VAN DYKE STREET.

Adopted

50 RLH AR 26-50 Ratifying the assessment for Demolition of Vacant, Nuisance and/or Hazardous Structure from the month of May 2026. (File No. J2607C, Assessment No. 262006)

Adopted

51 RLH AR 26-52 Ratifying the assessment for Emergency Sewer Repair at 777 OHIO STREET, fees billed during the month of April 2026. (File No. J2602A, Assessment No. 268503)

Public hearing continued to October 14, 2026

ADJOURNMENT

Meeting ended at 4:40 PM

City Council meetings are open for in person attendance, but the public may also comment on public hearing items in writing. Any comments and materials submitted by 12:00 pm of the day before the meeting will be attached to the public record and available for review by the City Council. Comments may be submitted as follows:

Written public comment on public hearing items can be submitted to Contact-Council@ci.stpaul.mn.us or CouncilHearing@ci.stpaul.mn.us. Live testimony will be taken in person in the Council Chambers.

Council Meeting Information
The City Council is paperless which saves the environment and reduces expenses. The agendas and Council files are all available on the Web (see below). Council members use mobile devices to review the files during the meeting. Using a mobile device greatly reduces costs since most agendas, including the documents attached to files, are over 1000 pages when printed.

Web
Meetings are available on the Council's website. Email notification and web feeds (RSS) of newly released minutes, agendas, and meetings are available by subscription. Visit www.stpaul.gov/council for meeting videos and updated copies of the agendas, minutes, and supporting documents.

Cable
Meetings are live on St Paul Channel 18 and replayed at various times. Check your local listings.